

# The Clinician's AI Safety Check

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The 30 second check clinicians  
should run before using AI at work.

A three stage, nine question framework  
for NHS clinicians using consumer AI  
tools in clinical work.

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Run this check every time.  
30 seconds. Then decide.

# This is a check, not a guide.

Run it before each use — not once at the start.

The framework has three stages:

**01****Before using the tool****02****While using the tool****03****After using the tool**

Each stage contains three questions.

You must answer yes to every question  
before proceeding.

If you cannot answer yes:



Do not use the tool yet



Use the tool differently



Ask your IG lead before proceeding

## IMPORTANT

Consumer AI tools — including ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude, Otter, and Magpie — are not NHS-procured systems.

They have not been assessed against:

- DCB0129
- DCB0160

Treat anything you upload as potentially used for AI training somewhere in the chain.

Composite scenarios.

**Unsafe input.**

Real patient information.



## WARNING

**Unsafe input example:**  
“Mrs Smith from yesterday.”

**Do not enter identifiable  
information.**

**A composite scenario is:**

“An older adult several weeks post-stroke living at home with a spouse.”

**When in doubt,  
ask your IG lead.**



# Before you open the tool

Ask these three questions before opening any AI tool.

## CHECK 1

### Have I changed the patient or scenario into a composite?

A composite describes a patient type — not a real person.

#### IDENTIFIABLE (Do not use)

##### Mrs S

(Not based on a real patient)



-  83 years old
-  Stroke 3 weeks ago
-  Lives alone in Stratford
-  Seen yesterday afternoon
-  Referred by Dr A. Khan
-  Newham Hospital, Ward B
-  Mobilises with frame, 1-person assist



#### COMPOSITE (Safe to use)

##### Mrs S Composite

(Protected scenario)



-  Older adult (80s)
-  Several weeks post-stroke
-  Lives alone at home
-  Recent clinical review
-  Under care of multidisciplinary team
-  Acute hospital setting
-  Mobilises with walking aid, needs supervision

## CHECK 2

### Have I removed every identifying combination?

Single details rarely identify a patient. Combinations do.

Age + condition + area + living situation can narrow to one person in your service.

#### Stay at the population level:

- older adult
- several weeks
- post-stroke
- lives alone at home

Combinations identify patients — not single details.

# While you are using the tool

Ask these three questions while using the AI tool.

## CHECK 4

Am I keeping the scenario at composite level, even when the AI asks for more detail?

AI tools may ask follow-up questions that increase identifiability.

Examples:

“

“What is the patient’s name?”

“

“Which borough do they live in?”

Leave these fields blank or use placeholders.

## CHECK 5

Has every citation, guideline, and factual claim been verified?

AI tools:

- invent citations
- misquote sources
- provide broken links
- generate confidently incorrect information

**AI confidence is not evidence.**

## CHECK 6

If I realise I’ve made a mistake, do I know what to do?

If you accidentally post identifiable information:

- 1 Stop the session immediately
- 2 Delete the chat
- 3 Note what happened and which tool was used
- 4 Tell your IG lead today

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# After you have used the tool

Ask these three questions before saving, sharing, or using the output.

## CHECK 7

### Is this output for one specific patient I have assessed?

If yes, this usually sits within normal clinical practice — provided your Trust permits the AI workflow used to create it.

#### Examples:

- a written home exercise programme
- a personalised energy conservation plan
- ADL recommendations after a home visit



**Personalise** the output inside your Trust documentation systems.

**Date and version** every copy.

At the point of personalisation, it becomes part of the clinical record.

## CHECK 8

### Is this output intended for multiple patients or wider distribution?

If the material will be:

- reused
- displayed on a ward
- shared externally
- distributed across a service

different approval and governance processes may apply.

#### This usually sits under:

- Patient Information Group
- Communications Governance review process

#### Examples:

- Posters in clinical areas
- Service overview leaflets
- Patient surveys

## CHECK 9

### Have I dated, versioned, and filed the output correctly?

Keep three separate:



#### Library entries

Reusable templates built from composite scenarios.

#### Store in:

- personal workflow library
- service AI resource folder



#### Clinical records

Patient-specific outputs.

#### Store in:

- Trust documentation systems
- EPR

# Questions your IG lead can answer

Most clinicians do not know who their IG lead is until they urgently need them.



## Ask your line manager

They can tell you who your IG lead is and what local process to follow.



## Check your Trust intranet

Look for IG policies, AI guidance, and approved tools for clinical use.



## Find local guidance

Look for guidance on data protection, AI use, and reporting.

## Questions worth asking

- Is my Trust permissive or restrictive on consumer AI tools?
- Has my Trust procured any approved AI tools?
- Are there approved use cases I'm unaware of?
- What is the reporting process if I think I've made a mistake?
- Where should AI-assisted guidance be stored?



# If something goes wrong

Most instinct is to hide the mistake.  
Do the opposite.

**1**

## Stop

End the session immediately.

**2**

## Note

Write down:

- what was pasted
- when it happened
- which tool was used

**3**

## Tell

Inform your IG lead today.

**4**

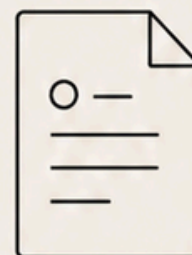
## Cooperate

Follow the process  
they recommend.

**5**

## Document

Record what happened  
and what advice was given.



The profession  
is more forgiving  
of reported  
mistakes than  
hidden ones.

## What this document is

This document is general professional guidance only.

It is designed to help clinicians think more safely about the use of consumer AI tools in clinical environments.

## What this document does not replace

This document does not replace:

- local Trust or organisational policy
- information governance guidance
- clinical governance procedures
- advice from your IG lead or governance team

## Consumer AI tools

The AI tools referenced in this document are consumer products.

They may not be approved for clinical use within your organisation and may not have been assessed against local governance, security, or clinical safety requirements.

## Your responsibility

Before applying any workflow described in this document, clinicians should ensure:

- local policy permits its use
- governance requirements are followed
- patient identifiable information is protected
- appropriate professional judgement is applied

Patient identifiable information should not be entered into consumer AI tools unless explicitly permitted within an approved organisational workflow.

## Important

Application of any workflow described remains the responsibility of the individual clinician and their organisation's local governance processes.

The views expressed are personal and do not represent the position of any NHS organisation or employer.

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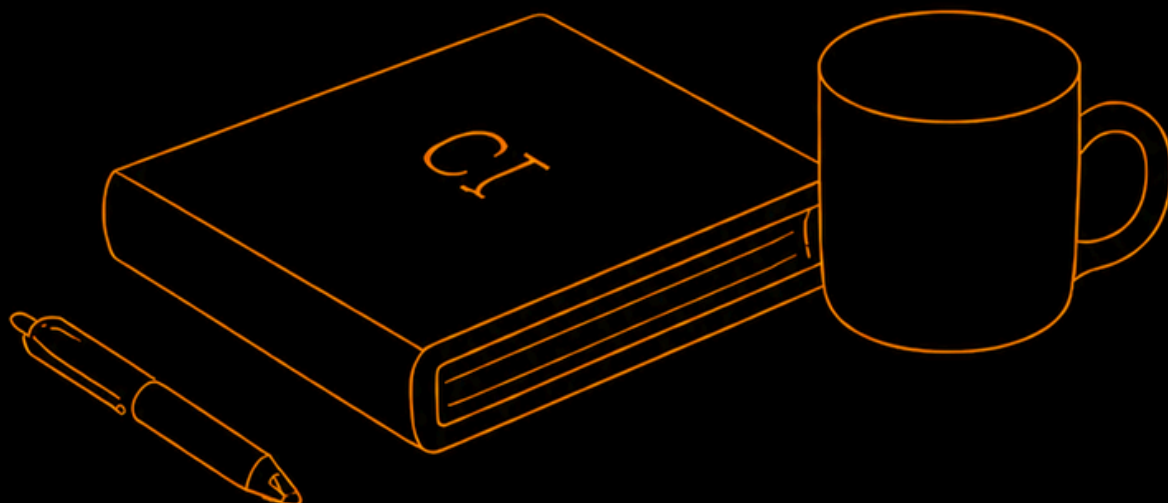
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Some clinicians will wait.  
Others will help shape what comes next.

**FIELD GUIDE 01**